

INTERNSHIP PROJECT REPORT

Title

The Effects of Waiting Time and Satisfaction Among Patients Visiting Psychiatry Outpatient Department of a Tertiary Care Hospital

Submitted by

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Institution

IIIT Dharwad

Internship Organization

IDRP

Duration

June 2025 to Aug 2025

Certificate

This is to certify that Dusary Charan and Bhoomika Mannur, students of IIIT Dharwad, have successfully completed their internship at IDRP from June 2025 to August 2025. During this

period, they worked on the project titled “The Effects of Waiting Time and Satisfaction Among Patients Visiting Psychiatry Outpatient Department of a Tertiary Care Hospital.”

Their work involved analyzing patient flow, waiting time, and satisfaction levels in a clinical environment. They demonstrated sincerity, technical competence, and a strong commitment throughout the internship.

Acknowledgment

We would like to express our sincere gratitude to IDRP for providing us with the opportunity to work on a meaningful and impactful project. We extend our thanks to our mentors and supervisors for their guidance, support, and valuable insights throughout the internship.

We also thank IIIT Dharwad for equipping us with the necessary knowledge and skills to undertake this work. Finally, we appreciate all individuals who directly or indirectly contributed to the successful completion of this project.

Abstract

This project focuses on analyzing the relationship between waiting time and patient satisfaction in the psychiatry outpatient department of a tertiary care hospital. Long waiting times are a critical factor influencing patient experience, especially in mental health services where patient comfort and engagement are essential.

The study aims to understand how delays in consultation affect patient satisfaction and identify potential areas for process improvement. Data was collected and analyzed to observe patterns in waiting time and its impact on patient perception. The findings provide insights that can help optimize hospital workflows and improve overall patient care quality.

Introduction

Background

Healthcare systems, particularly in tertiary care hospitals, often experience high patient inflow, leading to increased waiting times. In psychiatry departments, this issue becomes more significant due to the sensitive nature of mental health treatment and the need for timely attention.

Problem Statement

Extended waiting times in outpatient departments can negatively impact patient satisfaction, reduce trust in healthcare services, and affect treatment adherence.

Objectives

The primary objective of this project is to analyze the effect of waiting time on patient satisfaction and identify patterns that can help improve operational efficiency in the psychiatry outpatient department.

Project Overview

This project involves studying patient flow within the psychiatry outpatient department and evaluating how waiting time influences patient satisfaction levels. The work includes collecting relevant data, analyzing trends, and drawing meaningful conclusions to support decision-making in healthcare management.

The study aims to bridge the gap between patient expectations and hospital service delivery by identifying inefficiencies in the existing system.

Technology Stack

The project utilized a combination of tools and technologies for data collection, processing, and analysis. Data handling and analysis were carried out using standard computational tools, while visualization techniques were used to interpret trends effectively.

Appropriate tools were selected to ensure accuracy, efficiency, and clarity in presenting results.

System Architecture

The project follows a structured data analysis approach. Data is collected from the outpatient department, processed, and then analyzed to extract insights.

The workflow begins with data acquisition, followed by preprocessing to clean and organize the data. Analytical methods are then applied to identify patterns in waiting time and satisfaction levels. Finally, the results are interpreted and presented in a structured format.

Implementation Details

The implementation phase involved organizing the collected data and applying analytical techniques to evaluate the relationship between waiting time and patient satisfaction.

Different stages of the workflow included data preprocessing, statistical evaluation, and result interpretation. The analysis focused on identifying trends and correlations that could provide actionable insights for improving patient experience.

Challenges Faced

One of the primary challenges was handling inconsistent or incomplete data, which required careful preprocessing and validation.

Another challenge involved accurately measuring patient satisfaction, as it is subjective and influenced by multiple factors beyond waiting time.

Additionally, ensuring meaningful interpretation of the data required careful selection of analytical methods.

Results and Outcomes

The analysis revealed a noticeable relationship between increased waiting time and reduced patient satisfaction. Patients experiencing longer delays tended to report lower satisfaction levels.

The findings highlight the importance of optimizing patient flow and reducing waiting times to enhance the overall quality of healthcare services.

Future Enhancements

Future work can focus on implementing real-time monitoring systems to track patient flow and waiting time dynamically.

Advanced analytics and predictive models can be used to forecast patient load and optimize scheduling.

Integration with hospital management systems can further improve efficiency and patient experience.

Conclusion

This project successfully analyzed the impact of waiting time on patient satisfaction in a psychiatry outpatient department. The results emphasize the need for efficient healthcare management practices to reduce waiting times and improve patient outcomes.

The insights gained from this study can support hospitals in enhancing service quality and ensuring better patient care.